Usability Test Plan

The following document includes the research question, participant overview, testing methodology, and available data.

Goals and Research Question

- How well can users quickly and accurately locate information related to planning a sports-based event in Lubbock, TX?

The goals of usability testing include establishing and validating user performance and preference measures by addressing efficiency, error frequency, and user satisfaction. The usability test focuses specifically on the Lubbock Sports website's functionality as a tourism website and user experience while navigating it.

Participants

The usability test involved participants who would be potential users of the Visit Lubbock website. All six test participants met these conditions:

- Do not live within a 60-mile radius of Lubbock
- Between 25 to 65
- Attends or is involved in sporting events

Test Methodology

The testing sessions were conducted via video conferencing and screen-sharing tools, allowing the facilitator to guide participants through tasks and ask questions in real time.

The moderator briefed the participants on the Visit Lubbock website and instructed them that they are evaluating the application rather than being evaluated by the moderator. Participants signed an informed consent form acknowledging that participation is voluntary, that participation can cease at any time, and that the session will be videotaped, but their privacy and identification will be safeguarded

Participants completed a pretest demographic and background information questionnaire, which is available in Appendix A: Pretest Questionnaire.

The usability scenarios and tasks were identical for all participants of a given user role in the study. They are all available in Appendix B: Scenario and Tasks.

At the start of each task, the participant read aloud the task description from the printed copy and began the task. Time-on-task measurement begins when the participant starts the task. After each task, the participant completed the post-task questionnaire and elaborated on the task session with the facilitator. The facilitator instructed the participant to 'think aloud' so that a verbal record of their interaction with the website exists. They recorded user behavior, user comments, and system actions in the data log.

After all task scenarios were attempted, the moderator asked participants about their impressions of the site and testing experience. Part of the interview involved asking participants to select words from the “Product Reaction Cards” that describe their experience. See Appendix C: Debrief Interview and Product Reaction Cards.

Available Data

The data below is available to you on the testing data spreadsheet.

- Time to complete each task
- Test facilitator observations
- Think out loud comments and questions
- If the goal of the scenario was completed successfully
- If not, which specific task was NOT completed successfully
- Errors or difficulties the users encountered, regardless of whether the scenario was ultimately completed
- The specific tasks that seemed to be easiest for the user to accomplish
- Answers to debrief questions
- Product reaction cards chosen and why they chose those words

Appendix A: Pretest Questionnaire

1. What is your age?
    - 25-34
    - 35-44
    - 45-54
    - 55-65

2. What is your zip code?

3. What is your occupation?

4. What is the highest level of education you've completed?
    - Some high school
    - High school
    - Vocational program(s)
    - Some undergraduate
    - Undergraduate degree
    - Graduate/professional degree

5. How often do you use a computer?
    - Less than once a month
    - At least once a month
    - At least once a week
    - At least daily

6. How much time do you spend online weekly?
    - Less than 10 hours
    - 10-19 hours
    - 20-29 hours
    - 30-39 hours
    - 40-49 hours
    - 50 hours or more

7. Have you previously visited the Visit Lubbock Sports website?
    - Yes
    - No

Appendix B: Scenario and Tasks

Scenario One
You are the organizer of a middle school girls' soccer tournament with ten teams, and you're planning to hold the event in Lubbock next year. Your goal is to determine if adequate soccer facilities are available to accommodate all the teams and spectators expected to attend. You need to find detailed information on the rental options, including capacity and availability.

Tasks

1. Begin at the Lubbock Sports homepage and locate the section dedicated to sports facilities.
2. Identify soccer field rental options by navigating through the available facilities.
3. Find relevant details on the soccer field capacity and assess whether they can accommodate 10 teams and spectators.
4. Determine how to check the availability of the soccer fields for your desired event date.
5. Locate the contact information or online booking form to inquire further or secure the rental.
6. Say "I'm done" when you've completed these tasks.

Post-task Questions:
1. On a scale of 1 to 5 (1 being easy, 5 being hard), how would you rate the scenario you just performed?
2. What did you find most difficult in completing the scenario?
3. What did you find easiest in completing the scenario?

Scenario Two
In partnership with Lubbock Sports, you want to hold a sports festival at Lubbock Christian University. You would like the festival to support several sporting events simultaneously but don't know what types of facilities they offer. Your goal is to determine what types of facilities they can offer to get a better sense of what this festival can include. You want to use the Lubbock Sports website to see how many and what types of venues they offer.

Tasks:
1. Start at the Lubbock Sports homepage.
2. Find information on the facilities available at Lubbock Christian University.
3. Find the number and types of venues available at Lubbock Christian University.
4. Determine how many people you think each venue can accommodate.
5. Determine how you can find more information on their facilities.
6. Say "I'm done" when you feel you've completed these tasks.

Post-task Questions:

1. On a scale of 1 to 5 (1 being easy, 5 being hard), how would you rate the scenario you just performed?
2. What did you find most difficult in completing the scenario?
3. What did you find easiest in completing the scenario?

Scenario Three

You plan to attend a sporting event in Lubbock in May and will be driving from Austin, Texas. You want to use the Visit Lubbock website to get information about the distance, route, and local transportation options. You also want to know who to contact if you have further transportation-related questions.

Tasks:

1. Start at the Lubbock Sports homepage.
2. Locate information about the driving distance between Austin and Lubbock.
3. Find details about the number of major highways that intersect in Lubbock.
4. Search for information on local transportation options available after you arrive in Lubbock.
5. Locate where you can find contact details on the website if you have additional questions about transportation options.
6. Say “I’m done” when you feel you’ve completed these tasks.

Post-task Questions:

1. On a scale of 1 to 5 (1 being easy, 5 being hard), how would you rate the scenario you just performed?
2. What did you find most difficult in completing the scenario?
3. What did you find easiest in completing the scenario?

Appendix C: Debrief Interview and Product Reaction Cards

These questions are designed to have users reflect on their experiences with and provide feedback that they may not have expressed in the “think aloud” portion of the tasks.

Debrief Interview Script
Thank you so much for completing the tasks and providing your feedback. Now, I’d like to ask you a few follow-up questions to better understand your overall experience with the Visit Lubbock website."

This part of the session will be more open conversation, so feel free to be as detailed or as brief as you’d like. There are no right or wrong answers, and your honest thoughts and reactions will be really helpful to us.

Final Debrief Questions

- When you think about the site as a whole, how would you describe your overall experience? Did anything stand out to you, either positively or negatively?
- If you could make any change to the website, big or small, what would it be?
- On the other hand, was there anything you particularly liked or found helpful?
- Finally, on a scale from 1 to 5, with one being very poor and five being very good, how would you rate the website's overall quality? And why did you choose that rating?

Closing the Debrief Interview

That’s all for the debrief questions! Thanks again for sharing your thoughts; they’re incredibly helpful as we look for ways to improve the website. Before we wrap up, is there anything else you’d like to add or any final thoughts about your experience?

Product Reaction Cards

In this usability test, we will use Product Reaction Cards to gain qualitative feedback on participants’ emotional reactions after using the Visit Lubbock website, specifically related to ease of use, design, and overall functionality.

After each test session, participants will be presented with 25 descriptive words from an adapted version of the Microsoft Desirability Toolkit. Users will be asked to select 3 to 5 words that best describe their experience with the website. Once participants have chosen their words, we will conduct a brief debrief interview to understand the reasoning behind their selections.

The Microsoft Desirability Toolkit was chosen because of its previous use in UX research and because it allows users to choose from comprehensive and balanced vocabulary options to describe their reactions.

We adapted the original set of 118 words to 25 to ensure our users are not overwhelmed. The 25 words were chosen to create a mix of positive, negative, and neutral words and words that align with our overall research question.

Analyzing the chosen Product Reaction Cards will allow us to see possible patterns of emotional and experiential themes, which can help us understand further ways to improve the website.

List of Words for Product Reaction Cards

Positive Words

- Helpful – The site provided useful information that guided you effectively.
- Clear – The information and navigation were easy to understand.
- Easy to Use – The site was simple and intuitive to navigate.
- Organized – The layout and structure made sense and were easy to follow.
- Informative – The content provided valuable and detailed information.
- Professional – The site had a polished and reliable feel.
- Engaging – The website captured your attention and kept you interested.
- Fast – The site loaded quickly and responded well.
- Convenient – It was easy to find what you needed without hassle.
- Reliable – The site worked consistently without any issues.

Negative Words

- Confusing – It was hard to understand where to go or what to do.
- Frustrating – The experience made you feel annoyed or stuck.
- Difficult – Completing tasks or finding information was challenging.
- Unclear – The site lacked clarity in its instructions or layout.
- Slow – The site took too long to load or respond.
- Overwhelming – The information or layout felt too busy or complex.
- Incomplete – Key information or details were missing.
- Unorganized – The site felt chaotic or poorly structured.
- Inconsistent – The experience was not uniform throughout the site.
- Unreliable – Certain features didn't work as expected or frequently broke down.

Neutral Words

- Simple – The site's design or experience was basic but functional.
- Familiar – The site felt like something you've used before.
- Predictable – The experience was as expected, without surprises.
- Ordinary – The site didn't stand out, but it worked adequately.
- Straightforward – The tasks were clear, but nothing exceptional.